

10 The past continuous

The past continuous is used in English to talk about actions or events that were in progress at some time in the past. It is formed with “was” or “were” and a present participle.

See also:

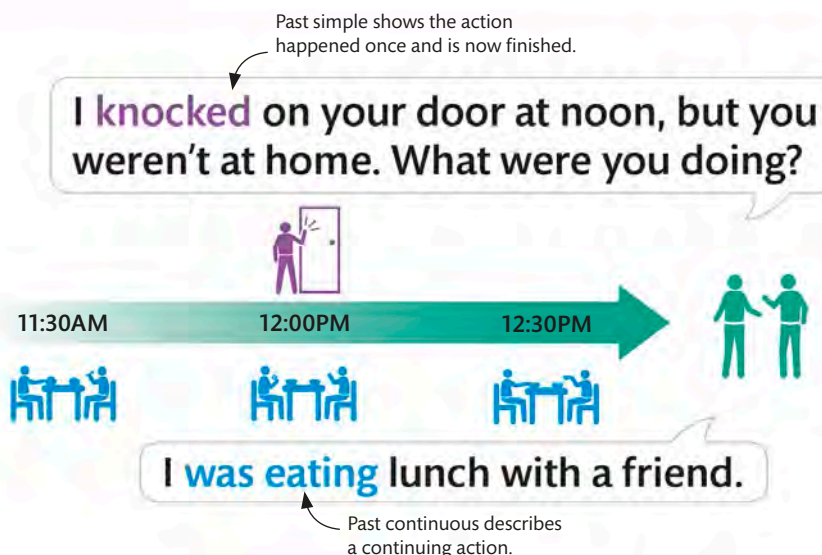
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10.1 THE PAST CONTINUOUS

English uses the past continuous to talk about ongoing actions that were in progress at a certain time in the past.

The past continuous shows the action went on for some time, but is now finished.



FURTHER EXAMPLES

This time last week,
we were hiking in Peru.



He didn't go out because
he was working late.



When I lost my camera,
we were swimming in the sea.



The last time I saw him,
he was washing his car.



HOW TO FORM

“Was” or “were” followed by the present participle form the past continuous.

